

CAMPAIGN TEARDOWN

Nº 01 — MARBELLA

How a bleeding
Marbella ad account
became a **qualified-
buyer machine** — on the
same budget.

↳ THE RESULT, UP FRONT

A real Meta campaign on the Costa del Sol —
€400,000–700,000 homes, sold to buyers across
Europe. Same ad budget, start to finish. Here's
what changed.

\$169 → \$31

COST PER QUALIFIED BUYER · -82%

50% → 73%

LEADS THAT QUALIFIED

35 → 138

LEADS · SAME SPEND

Daniel had already decided Meta didn't work.

Daniel sells property on the Costa del Sol—villas and apartments in the €400,000 to €700,000 range, mostly to buyers coming in from across Europe.

Good inventory. A market people genuinely want to buy into. On paper, the easiest thing in the world to advertise.

His ad account told a different story.

It kept getting shut off. He'd log in to find ads rejected, or the whole account flagged and throttled.

He'd appeal, wait it out, relaunch — and get hit again a week later. Every restriction cost him days of delivery and a fresh wave of frustration.

When the ads did run, they ran expensive. Eighty-four dollars a lead. And maybe half of those were worth calling. The rest were tire-kickers — wrong budget, wrong country, people who filled in a form on a whim and never picked up the phone.

The setup was giving Meta one instruction: find the easiest response at the lowest price. So it did. The result was the cheapest, least serious clicks it could find.

The account was losing money every month it ran.

By the time he reached out, he'd more or less written the channel off. Meta doesn't work for real estate, he figured. Time to go back to portals and referrals.

He was wrong about that. The channel was never the problem. He was fighting the algorithm instead of feeding it, and fighting Meta's housing rules instead of working around them.

"He wasn't losing to
Facebook.

He was losing to **the way he
was using it.**"

Real estate ads start with a handicap most people never diagnose.

Property ads on Meta fall under a Special Ad Category — Housing — and that category strips out most of the tools you'd normally reach for.

No ZIP-code targeting. No narrowing by interests. No audience exclusions. Your audience is forced wide — and housing ads get reviewed harder, so even clean, compliant ads get rejected on the first pass and need an appeal just to go live.

This is why so many agents try Meta once, watch their account get flagged and their leads come back junk, and quit — convinced the channel is broken.

It isn't broken. It's built to fight you until you understand how to work with it.

The account was optimising for the wrong outcome.

Meta was not failing to find people. It was learning from the easiest response it could get - a cheap form submission.

The rebuild started with a harder question: **what signals separate genuine buying intent from casual curiosity?**

That answer changed the account. The rebuild shifted the system from collecting responses to recognising intent before sales ever made contact.

The result came from three coordinated changes.

Not a secret audience. Not a bigger budget. Not one lucky creative.

We changed what the system learned from before a lead reached sales, and what Meta was rewarded for finding again.

Each change reinforced the others. Remove one, and the account drifted back toward cheap, low-commitment responses.

There was no single hack.

The account improved whenever a signal began pointing toward the same outcome: a qualified buyer.

Before we spent another dollar, we changed what the account was built to optimise for.

The original setup treated every enquiry as

equally valuable. It rewarded volume, even when sales could not use it.

The rebuild made buyer intent - not the form submission - the organising principle.

The budget stayed almost identical. The quality of the signals did not.

We stopped treating every buyer as the same buyer.

The same €500,000 property can be bought for completely different reasons. The original ads collapsed those motives into one generic message.

We separated the buying logic and built a different argument for each. The audience settings stayed broad; the message decided who recognised themselves in the offer.

The creative became the targeting.

We stopped treating every form submission as a lead.

The old journey rewarded curiosity. The rebuilt journey asked for a small act of commitment before a contact entered the sales pipeline.

No extra landing page. No new software. But fake and accidental submissions began disappearing before sales touched them.

Lead volume mattered less than the signal behind it.

The first 10 minutes became part of the campaign.

Even the best algorithm cannot close a deal if the follow-up is slow or generic.

We replaced the standard catalogue email with a strict 10-minute conversational protocol. The first contact restored context, matched the prospect's buying logic and moved the conversation to one specific next step.

The ad did not end at the form. Neither did the system.

The smallest adjustment produced the clearest jump in quality.

One change at the point of enquiry removed a

large share of low-commitment submissions before sales contacted them.

No new software. No external landing page. No increase in ad spend.

Combined with the rest of the rebuild, the qualified share rose from **50% to 73%.**

BEFORE - ORIGINAL ACCOUNT

\$84.71 / lead

All ads Actions Had delivery Active ads See more										
Describe what you're looking for										
Campaigns 7 selected Ad sets for 7 Campaigns Ads for 7 Campaigns										
Create Duplicate Edit A/B test More Columns: Copy of Performance a										
Off / On	Ad ID	Reach	Budget Ad set	Amount spent	Impressions	Link clicks	CPC (cost per link click)	Leads	Cost per lead	CTR (link c through ra
			35,688 \$165.00 Daily	\$82.53	60,652	71	\$1.16	3	\$82.53	
			3,089 \$165.00 Daily	\$169.38	4,643	17	\$9.96	—	—	
			4,031 \$165.00 Daily	\$178.27	5,919	19	\$9.38	—	—	
			7,777 \$125.00 Daily	\$25.68	8,587	76	\$0.34	2	\$12.84	
			48,029 \$165.00 Daily	\$175.81	87,999	170	\$1.03	3	\$58.60	
			1,842 \$125.00 Daily	\$6.81	2,039	8	\$0.85	2	\$3.41	
			41,359 \$165.00 Daily	\$128.48	76,518	148	\$0.87	—	—	
			3,401 \$165.00 Daily	\$130.99	4,723	6	\$21.83	1	\$130.99	
			3,730 \$125.00 Daily	\$11.84	4,189	30	\$0.39	1	\$11.84	
			1,820 \$165.00 Daily	\$76.11	2,511	5	\$15.22	1	\$76.11	
			37,531 \$165.00 Daily	\$141.75	61,600	137	\$1.03	2	\$70.88	
			2,708 \$125.00 Daily	\$13.12	3,249	14	\$0.94	3	\$4.37	
			4,704 Using campaign bu...	\$197.90	7,440	68	\$2.91	2	\$98.95	
			21,092 Using campaign bu...	\$400.11	34,974	150	\$2.67	4	\$100.03	
			23,363 Using campaign bu...	\$536.00	31,797	55	\$9.75	6	\$89.33	
			2,741 Using campaign bu...	\$195.90	3,853	22	\$8.90	2	\$97.95	
			5,615 Using campaign bu...	\$301.61	7,279	21	\$14.36	3	\$100.54	
			Meta Accounts	Total spent	Total	Total	Per Action	Total	Per Action	
			222,497	\$2,964.90	464,391	1,208	\$2.45	35	\$84.71	

Actual Ads Manager export. \$2,964.90 spent, rows running for days with nothing to show. Creative withheld at the client's request.

AFTER - REBUILT ACCOUNT

\$22.44 / lead

All ads

Actions

Had delivery

Active ads

See more

Describe what you're looking for

Campaigns

4 selected

Ad sets for 4 Campaigns

Ads for 4 Campaigns

Create

Duplicate

Edit

A/B test

More

Columns: Copy of Performance and

Off / On	Ts	Ad Ts	Reach Ts	Budget Ad set	Amount spent Ts	Impressions Ts	Link clicks Ts	CPC (cost per link click)	Ts	Leads Ts	Cost per lead Ts	CTR (link click through rate)
CREATIVE PROTECTED			3,641	Using campaign be...	\$176.96	5,480	158	\$1.12	6		\$29.69	
			7,852	Using campaign be...	\$198.24	11,152	83	\$2.39	6		\$33.04	
			16,414	Using campaign be...	\$291.18	21,657	192	\$1.52	8		\$36.40	
			9,182	Using campaign be...	\$206.76	11,460	134	\$1.54	31		\$18.80	
			53,064	Using campaign be...	\$355.12	81,355	387	\$0.92	60		\$8.88	
			3,948	Using campaign be...	\$36.86	4,887	21	\$1.76	6		\$6.16	
			9,406	Using campaign be...	\$99.28	11,797	37	\$2.68	12		\$8.27	
			39,044	Using campaign be...	\$1,014.93	54,288	351	\$2.89	24		\$42.29	
			18,713	Using campaign be...	\$715.41	36,873	119	\$6.01	25		\$18.62	
			52	Using campaign be...	\$2.28	58		—			—	
Results file			164,490		\$3,097.02	239,007	1,482	\$2.09	138		\$22.46	
Meta Accounts					Total spent	Total	Total	Per Action	Total		Per Action	

Same export, after the rebuild. \$3,097.02 spent — almost the same budget — at more than double the click-through rate.

06 SAME BUDGET — THE RESULT

METRIC	BEFORE	AFTER
SPEND	\$2,964	\$3,097
IMPRESSIONS	464,391	239,007
LINK CLICKS	1,208	1,482
CTR	0.26%	0.62%
LEADS	35	138
COST / LEAD	\$84.71	\$22.44
QUALIFIED	~50%	~73%

COST PER QUALIFIED BUYER

\$169 → \$31

~18 qualified leads became ~101 — same spend. Nearly 6x the real buyers, 82% cheaper each.

Impressions dropped almost in half
— yet leads nearly **quadrupled**.

We stopped paying to show the ad to the wrong people. That gap — fewer impressions, far more leads — is the whole point: the difference between buying attention and buying the right attention.

This was one account, in one market, at one price point.

The numbers are specific to the Costa del Sol.

The decision framework that produced them is not.

The same logic can be used to diagnose where an account loses intent, decide what to change, and measure whether lead quality actually improved.

**Change the city. Change the property value.
The decision system still holds.**

Marbella was one city. The system isn't.

A method is only worth anything if it survives a different market.

So here is the same decision framework producing commercially viable buyer enquiries in three more markets - across very different property values, geographies and levels of demand.

MARKET 02 — DUBAI · \$500K-1M

\$51.70 / lead

Campaigns

7 selected

Ad sets for 7 Campaigns

Ads for 7 Campaigns

+ Create

+ Duplicate

+ Edit

+ A/B test

+ More

Columns: Copy of Performance

Off / On	Ts	Ad Ts	Actions	R...	Ts	Amount spent Ts	Link clicks Ts	CPC (cost per link click) Ts	Leads Ts	Cost per lead Ts	Impres...	Ts
				20,128		\$656.13	171	\$3.84	12	\$38.60		33,681
				5,718		\$241.67	38	\$6.36	1	\$241.67		9,411
				11,517		\$362.45	83	\$4.37	2	\$51.78		21,036
				10,102		\$362.56	83	\$4.37	2	\$51.79		17,476
				11,314		\$295.11	71	\$4.16	6	\$78.78		15,896
				12,961		\$438.07	113	\$3.88	6	\$78.01		21,776
				9,295		\$323.93	49	\$6.61	6	\$80.98		14,608
				9,993		\$325.44	45	\$7.23	6	\$81.36		19,171
				12,532		\$325.85	79	\$4.12	6	\$81.66		24,794
				11,566		\$324.47	64	\$5.07	6	\$81.12		21,016
				5,434		\$194.85	12	\$9.57	—	—		6,461
				6,023		\$195.32	17	\$4.78	—	—		8,061
				12,621		\$502.75	89	\$5.65	6	\$83.29		23,301
				5,790		\$237.22	24	\$9.88	3	\$79.07		7,576
				18,777		\$491.58	132	\$3.42	10	\$49.16		27,241
				18,216		\$501.24	105	\$3.23	11	\$45.57		30,116
				72,850		\$2,823.73	2,400	\$1.09	71	\$36.95		235,225
				151,138		\$6,427.80	3,717	\$2.27	163	\$51.70		550,721
						Total spent	Total	Per Action	Total	Per Action		

163 buyer leads across \$8,428 in spend. Off-plan and ready units in a highly competitive international market. Creative withheld.

\$17.24 / lead

Campaigns

5 selected

Ad sets for 5 Campaigns

Ads for 5 Campaigns

+ Create

Duplicate

Edit

A/B test

More

Columns: Copy of Perfor

Off / On	Ad %	Actions	R...	Amount spent %	Link clicks %	CPC (cost per link click) %	Leads %	Cost per lead %	Impressio...
			20,128	\$656.13	171	\$3.84	37	\$38.60	33,681
			1,617	\$26.70	3	\$8.90	3	\$26.70	1,812
			14,247	\$213.14	45	\$4.74	8	\$26.64	19,309
			31,689	\$400.14	135	\$2.96	21	\$19.05	50,073
			1,742	\$17.88	3	\$5.96	—	—	1,987
			377	\$2.62	2	\$1.31	—	—	417
			2,582	\$18.80	4	\$4.70	3	\$18.80	2,985
			909	\$1.07	—	—	—	—	120
			11,546	\$179.86	187	\$0.96	16	\$12.85	24,661
			20,318	\$186.87	181	\$1.03	32	\$15.57	43,004
			50,270	\$637.50	881	\$0.72	50	\$12.75	119,769
			7	\$0.04	—	—	—	—	7
			2,693	\$52.04	17	\$3.06	4	\$13.01	4,428
			3,893	\$55.98	20	\$2.80	4	\$14.00	5,788
			2	\$0.00	—	—	—	—	2
			29	\$0.16	—	—	—	—	30
			8,389	\$199.89	50	\$4.00	32	\$16.66	14,728
			44	\$4.44	—	—	—	—	44
			152,736	\$3,240.57	2,707	\$1.54	188	\$17.24	400,459
			Meta Acce...	Total spent	Total	Per Action	Total	Per Action	Total

188 leads on \$3,241 in a lower-priced European market. Different economics, the same decision framework underneath.

\$68.52 / lead

Campaigns											
10 selected											
Ad sets for 10 Campaigns											
Ad sets for 10 Campaigns											
Columns: Copy of Performance											
Off / On	Ad T1	Reach T1	Budget Per set	Amount spent T1	Impressions T1	Link clicks T1	CPC (cost per link click)	Leads T1	Cost per lead T1		
			4,235	\$35.00 Daily	\$387.30	7,528	47	\$8.24	9	\$43.03	
			5,222	\$35.00 Daily	\$468.87	9,173	28	\$5.32	6	\$37.22	
			4,340	\$35.00 Daily	\$94.82	7,290	12	\$7.90	—	—	
			20,276	\$35.00 Daily	\$237.25	23,232	96	\$2.47	2	\$118.63	
			9,387	\$35.00 Daily	\$799.33	9,447	55	\$3.62	2	\$99.67	
			1,406	\$35.00 Daily	\$40.66	1,511	5	\$8.13	1	\$40.66	
			6,921	\$35.00 Daily	\$208.79	12,477	39	\$5.35	3	\$69.60	
			9,337	\$35.00 Daily	\$282.47	17,099	61	\$4.63	6	\$70.62	
			14,110	\$35.00 Daily	\$173.14	20,364	122	\$1.42	6	\$43.29	
			12,781	\$35.00 Daily	\$391.58	15,688	77	\$5.16	6	\$99.60	
			3,975	\$35.00 Daily	\$755.87	4,834	25	\$6.23	—	—	
			44,972	\$35.00 Daily	\$669.17	65,391	328	\$2.04	34	\$47.80	
			4,813	\$45.00 Daily	\$58.32	6,001	10	\$5.83	—	—	
			8,346	\$45.00 Daily	\$245.23	12,238	21	\$11.68	—	—	
			5,800	\$45.00 Daily	\$144.42	9,388	28	\$5.16	6	\$35.50	
			297	\$35.00 Daily	\$177.87	297	4	\$4.47	—	—	
			837	\$35.00 Daily	\$38.25	890	1	\$38.25	—	—	
			134	\$35.00 Daily	\$219.03	134	4	\$219.03	—	—	
			202,880	\$6,029.32 Total spent	\$59,972	1,611	\$3.74 Per Action	88	\$68.52 Per Lead		

88 leads on \$6,029, at the very top of the market. A \$69 lead against an \$800K-3M sale is the kind of math that closes.

Marbella

€400–700K · the teardown

\$22 /lead

Dubai

\$500K–1M

\$52 /lead

Warsaw

\$150–300K

\$17 /lead

United States

\$800K–3M

\$69 /lead

Costs change with the market and property value.

The system continued to produce commercially viable buyer enquiries across all four. Change the city. Change the property. **The decision framework holds.**

THE FULL SYSTEM

The Real Estate **Meta** Playbook

The complete operating system behind this teardown - how to diagnose weak signals, build qualified demand, improve follow-up, and decide what to scale or kill. Built from **\$1M in real estate Meta spend** across seven markets.

Get the Playbook

onlymarketing.site